

The Boron Group

This group contains five natural elements and one artificial element called nihonium (Nh). Although these elements are not very reactive, none of them are found in a pure form in nature. Boron (B), the first member, is a semi-metal (an element that has properties of both metals and non-metals), while the rest are metals. The second member, aluminium (Al), is the most common metal in Earth's rocks.



Atomic structure

Members of this group have three electrons in the outer shell of every atom. Some elements have unstable isotopes.



Physical properties

All elements, except boron, are shiny solids. Every member of this group is soft, except for boron (B), which is one of the hardest elements.



Chemical properties

Most of the elements don't react with water. Aluminium (Al) forms an oxide layer in water, and can react with it when this layer is corroded.



Compounds

They form compounds by losing electrons to other elements. All of them react with oxygen (O) by bonding to three oxygen atoms.